

a) Changing the original file location will have ramifications in After Effects. The composition will not exist for that element because the linking has been broken and it will show an error.

b) Similarly, changing the file name after importing will also make the composition useless as it is again, no longer linked.

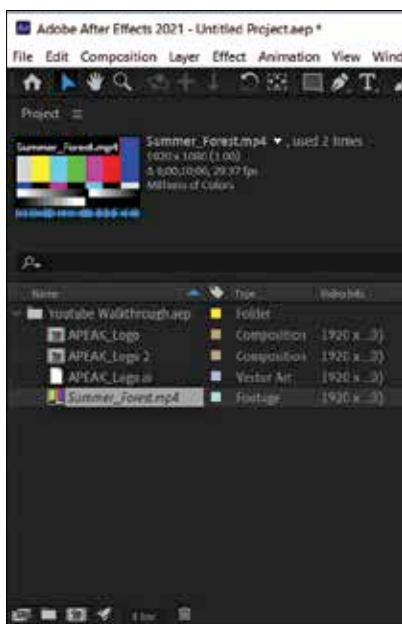
Sometimes, you may have so many elements from so many different locations that you might want to find out the source of the file from the element itself. You can do this by right-clicking the element → Reveal in Explorer. There is a fix for both the errors above (in case the element is misplaced or misspelt after importing into AE).

a) If the location of the file has been changed. You need to right click the element → Replace Footage and then choose the file from its new location. This will create a new link.

b) If the file has been renamed (by accident for example), you can either use the Replace Footage option and do the same thing again or you can revert the file name to its previous name and then right click the element → Reload Footage.

Both of these options work equally well and you have reversed the damage.

A representation of what will happen if an element is delinked has been provided. The digital noise symbol takes center stage in the composition panel. An intuitive piece of design here is that this symbol also carries over to every instance of the element in After Effects to signify to us that the link is broken and that it either needs to be fixed or removed. Only the delinked layer is affected in the composition and the other elements are still intact but if this isn't fixed the composition as a whole is an



Once the link is broken, this is what AE will display to show that there is an error with the object. A very intuitive part of the design here is that the icon of the element also turns into this noise image